# The Second Vessel: The 1135 San Juan de la Peña Act, the North Atlantic Corridor, and the Threshold Hypothesis

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## Abstract

This paper homes in on the factual spine of a long-running investigation: the lineage of two precious-stone vessels recorded in a single act of 13 November 1135, in which Ramiro II of Aragon took a stone chalice and a stone urceus from the monastery of San Juan de la Peña to mint emergency coinage at Jaca. The act is quoted verbatim from its printed edition and parchment photograph; the vessels' lineage is carried forward on dated documents — the 1399 handover letters, the 1410 royal inventory, the 1437 cathedral deposit — to the composite reliquary now in Valencia Cathedral, whose plain agate foot is identified in the Spanish literature as an urceus mounted in the twelfth century. The corridor on which these vessels sat is presented as a dated lineage of documented voyages from Pytheas (c. 325 BC) to the Bristol customs accounts (1453/1517). The author's Threshold hypothesis — that the Grail of the fables was a plain stone vessel of northern origin whose water restores — is stated as his position, with one paragraph separating what the record carries from what it does not. The decisive open test is identified: the mounting-date technical file on the Valencia foot.

**Keywords:** San Juan de la Peña; Ramiro II; Santo Cáliz; urceus; medieval maritime corridor; evidence ledger; Grail

## 1. The question and the method

The question is narrow: a monastery in the Pyrenees held two precious-stone vessels in 1135; a king took both; the record then goes silent on one of them. Where did the second vessel go? The method is the evidence ledger: every claim graded VHR (verified record), DCR (documented reconstruction), HYP (hypothesis), or SPC (speculation); negative results entered as findings; every step cited to an edition, a shelfmark, a DOI, or a dated computation.[1] Nothing in this paper is asserted beyond its grade.

## 2. The act of 13 November 1135

The act survives as a contemporary copy: AHN, Clero, San Juan de la Peña, leg. 444, no. 257, printed with parchment photograph as Ubieto Arteta's doc. 4 (1951).[2] Issued at Jaca, *die sancti Bricii*, era 1173 (13 November 1135). Its operative clause:

> *"…per illo calice de lapide precioso et per uno urceo similiter de lapide precioso que traxit de sancto Iohanne et per illam tabulam de argento et de superaurata quam traxi de Sancta Maria de Ibozar per meam monetam facere de Iacha … et ipso die mutavit domnus rex illa moneta in Iacha."*

"…for that chalice of precious stone and for that urceus, likewise of precious stone, which he took from San Juan, and for that gilded silver tablet which he took from Santa María de Ibozar, to make his coinage at Jaca … and on that same day the lord king changed the coinage at Jaca." In exchange, the monastery and Iguácel received three Garcipollera villas (Villa Novella, Bescosse, Osse) in perpetual possession.[3] The silver was weighed out in marks of fine silver (the printed variants — forty or fifty marks — concern this silver tablet, not the vessels).[4] Witnesses: abbot Eximino of San Juan, bishop Dodo, viscountess Talesa of Béarn, and Lope Sangiz, merino of Jaca, "*qui aduxit illo argento*" — who delivered the material.[5]

The context is documented emergency: the nobility revolt of October 1135 (the Campana de Huesca affair), Alfonso VII's occupation of Zaragoza, and a crown stripping treasure to mint loyalty. Companion acts bracket it: November 1134 — a gold chalice of 774 mithqals with 85 gems, compensated at Bailo; 1137 — 500 marks of silver "*quos traxi de Sancto Iohanne*."[67] The legal form is final alienation: no pledge, no redemption, no return clause.[8] Metal can be minted; stone cannot. The last documented custody of the urceus is therefore the crown's mint operation at Jaca, 13 November 1135 — and after that day, no record mentions it again.[9]

### 3. The lineage of the vessels, 1135 to the present

What the dated record carries, step by step:

- **1135** — the act above: two stone vessels leave San Juan for the mint. VHR.[10]
- **1322** — Jaime II writes to the Mamluk sultan requesting the Cáliz: the crown on record that it does not believe San Juan holds the true vessel. VHR.[11]
- **1399** — at the Aljafería, 26 September: Martín I requests of San Juan "*illum Calicem lapideum … quem beatus Laurencius … misit et dedit cum eius litera Monasterio … sancti Johannis de la Penya*" — the stone chalice given to the monastery by St Lawrence "with his letter." The same correspondence references a "*carta del rey*" — a lost donation charter of an unnamed earlier king, carried with the cup (ACA reg. 2242, f. 171, 29 August 1399). VHR.[12][13]
- **1410** — the royal inventory (ACA Ms. 136) describes the composite as it stands today: cup, foot, and mount. VHR.[14]
- **1437** — deposit at Valencia Cathedral (ACV vol. 3532, f. 36v); in the same era the vessel is pledged for ~137,430 sueldos and redeemed — an object valuable enough to bank a war. VHR.[15]
- **1744 / 1960** — the cup breaks and is repaired; Beltrán dismounts the composite in 1960 and examines the three parts separately. VHR.[16][17]
- **2026** — the UPV metrology study publishes the cup's measurements (mouth 96.44–97.85 mm; volume 235 ml). VHR.[18]

The composite's three parts, per the dismount and the literature: a banded-agate cup (Hellenistic-Roman, c. 100 BC–1st c. AD); a gold mount with gems documented from 1399; and **a plain, inverted agate/chalcedony vessel as the foot** — Islamic workmanship, Córdoba/Fatimid, 10th–12th century, bearing the Kufic inscription *li-l-Zāhira* (a Medina Azahara association).[19][20]

### 4. The second vessel: the foot

The Spanish archaeological literature describes the Valencia composite's assembly in one sentence: the cup was "*alhajado en el s. XII con un urceus, utilizado tal vez como naveta y ahora como pie*" — mounted in the twelfth century with an urceus, perhaps used as an incense boat, now as the foot.[21] Set against the act: in 1135 exactly two precious-stone vessels leave one house at one moment; in the twelfth century exactly two stone vessels are fused into one object. The identification — **the 1135 urceus survives as the foot of the Valencia composite** — is graded HYP, and the ledger keeps the counters on the board: Mafé's dating of the mounting to 1071, if sustained, eliminates the identification and makes the 1135 urceus a genuinely lost vessel (San Juan's fires of 1494 and 1675 supply the mundane ends); the word *urceus* (pitcher) sits loosely on an oval naveta; no return document to San Juan survives.[22][23] The identification has circulated in popular literature with an unsupported mechanism (a royal goldsmith commission); the act records seizure and compensation, not a commission.[24]

One test decides it: **the mounting-date technical file** — Beltrán's 1960 dismount documentation and the cathedral's technical file on the foot, together with the UPV 2026 raw data. If the fusion postdates 1135, the second vessel has been

hiding in plain sight, carrying the famous cup on its back for six centuries.[25][26]

## 5. The corridor the vessels sat on

The vessels' house stood on a working sea corridor, documented as a dated lineage (distances computed on WGS84; grades per entry):[27]

| Date | Documented movement on the corridor | Grade |
|---|---|---|
| c. 325 BC | Pytheas sails Massalia → Britain → Thule, "six days north of Britain," the congealed sea beyond | VHR text[28] |
| c. 300 BC | Hecataeus records the island beyond the Celts with Apollo's priests, the spherical temple, the nineteen-year visit | VHR text[29] |
| 563 | Columba crosses to Iona | VHR[30] |
| c. 590s | Cormac reaches Orkney under royal protection, then runs 14 days and nights due north | VHR text[31] |
| c. 795 / 825 | Clerici winter–summer on Thule; the frozen sea one day beyond; Dicuil writes it down | VHR[32] |
| to c. 870 | The papar resident on the northern islands a century before the Norse; the Papa place-names remain | VHR[33] |
| 1101 | The Sacro Catino — Islamic green glass — taken at Caesarea, later called a Grail | VHR object[34] |
| **1135** | **The two stone vessels taken to the Jaca mint** | **VHR**[35] |
| 1153 | Earl Harald's party shelters in Orkahaugr in the Christmas snow | VHR[36] |
| 1308 | Danet in Ireland two days before the arrest orders (sea passage inferred) | VHR posting[37] |
| 1399 | The stone chalice leaves San Juan for the crown | VHR[38] |
| 1453 / 1517 | Julian of Bristol (Lisbon → Ireland hides); Santa Maria of Caudelars (Bristol → Ireland) | VHR[39][40] |
| 1976–77 | Severin sails the northern arc in a leather boat; an ice-hole patched at sea | DCR[41] |

No era lacks a hull on the corridor; the nine-leg chain from Alexandria to the ice edge measures 8,349 km and breaks nowhere for period vessels — the return south is the easy direction, and the medieval ice edge stood farther north than today's.[42][43] No document joins one named hull across two legs, and none is claimed.[44][45]

## 6. The Threshold hypothesis, stated as held

The author's position, recorded as such: the Grail of the fables was a plain stone vessel of the northern Threshold people; it moved down the corridor; the ornate exhibited cups are the decoys; and the fables' promise — water that heals or suspends death from a stone — is the motif-shape the object carried, a motif documented from the Egyptian cippus rite (water poured over inscribed stone and drunk) through Columba's white quartz to Wolfram's grail-stone.[46][47][48] What the record carries: the

corridor, the dated vessel documents, the second vessel's shadow. What it does not carry, and this paper does not claim: a custody chain, a mechanism demonstrated in physics or biology, or a hand sample from any candidate bed — the Antarctic clause stands parked under written resurrection conditions, and the curling-stone clause is on record as inverting ailsite's actual waterproof physics.[495051] The hypothesis lives where the documents live: on the lineage of the second vessel.

## 7. Conclusion

The facts are these: a dated act takes two precious-stone vessels out of San Juan de la Peña in 1135 and into a mint; the composite that surfaces by 1399 fuses a Roman agate cup with a plain Islamic stone vessel as its foot; the literature calls that foot an urceus mounted in the twelfth century; and one technical file — the mounting date — decides whether the second vessel of 1135 has been standing under the famous cup all along. The lineage, the dates, and the citations are now on the record, graded. The next move is a letter, not a theory.

## Acknowledgments and reproducibility

Archival cross-checks, computations, and adversarial review were executed under the author's evidence-ledger protocol with a research-agent swarm (Kimi, Moonshot AI), 5–6 October 2026; verifier criteria v1–v6 and all run logs are retained. No archive outreach was sent; the request texts for the four decisive documents (Valencia technical file; ACA reg. 2242 f. 171; ACA Ms. 136; AHN leg. 444 no. 257) are drafted in the sitting ledgers' appendices.

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1. Aureon Institute review pack and sitting ledgers, 1–6 October 2026 (Master Ledger v1/v2; Ship's Logs; Urceus Trace; Water-Stone Pattern; verifier runs 1–7).↩

2. A. Ubieto Arteta, "Documentos para el estudio de la numismática navarro-aragonesa medieval, 1ª serie," PSANA 1 (1951), 113–135, doc. 4 (pp. 115–117), parchment photograph; scan: Instituto de Estudios Pirenaicos, https://ifc.dpz.es/recursos/publicaciones/00/63/05ubieto.pdf; AHN, Clero, San Juan de la Peña, leg. 444, no. 257.↩

3. Ubieto Arteta, doc. 4 — the 1135 act (n. 2 above).↩

4. P. Beltrán Villagrasa, PSANA 21–22 (1964), https://ifc.dpz.es/recursos/publicaciones/02/13/05beltran.pdf.↩

5. Ubieto Arteta, doc. 4 — the 1135 act (n. 2 above).↩

6. See n. 3 above.↩

7. J. M. Lacarra, on the 1134/1135 acts and Ramiro II's requisitions, *Príncipe de Viana* 48–49, https://culturanavarra.es/uploads/files/02-PV48-49-pagina0263.pdf.↩

8. Ubieto Arteta, doc. 4 — the 1135 act (n. 2 above).↩

9. Absence verified against the published Aragonese inventory tradition and the San Juan dispersal literature (Artigrama 20, 2005, papiro.unizar.es/ojs/index.php/artigrama/article/view/8320).↩

10. Ubieto Arteta, doc. 4 — the 1135 act (n. 2 above).↩

11. Jaime II to the Mamluk sultan, 1322 (ACA correspondence), per Martín Lloris & Gómez-Ferrer (2022/2025).↩

12. ACA, pergaminos 136 (26 Sept 1399), text per M. Martín Lloris, PhD thesis (Universitat de València, 2010), https://www.tdx.cat/bitstream/handle/10803/52188/martin.pdf.↩

13. ACA reg. 2242, f. 171; the 1399 letters verbatim in the Valencia civic report, https://cvcultura.es/wp-content/uploads/750-Informe-Sant-Calze-amb-vots-particulars-final-1.pdf.↩

14. ACA Ms. 136 (1410 inventory), per Rodríguez Almenar, *Memoria Ecclesiae* 35, https://scrinia.org/wp-content/uploads/2021/12/Memoria-Ecclesiae-35.pdf.↩

15. ACV vol. 3532, f. 36v (1437 deposit); the pledge (18 Mar 1437, ~137,430 sueldos) per the cathedral archive's historical account, https://rhscvalencia.es/historia-del-santo-caliz-de-la-cena/; archivist: V. Pons Alós.↩

16. See n. 9 above.↩

17. *Arqueología* (Instituto de Estudios Altoaragoneses), on the Santo Cáliz components — "alhajado en el s. XII con un urceus, utilizado tal vez como naveta y ahora como pie," https://revistas.iea.es/index.php/ARG/article/view/1635/1631; cathedral's official description, https://catedraldevalencia.es/el-santo-caliz/sobre-el-santo-caliz/.↩

18. Universitat Politècnica de València, Santo Cáliz metrology (2026), *Journal of Cultural Heritage*, https://doi.org/10.1016/j.culher.2026.05.016.↩

19. See n. 9 above.↩

20. IEA/ARG on the Santo Cáliz components (n. 11 above).↩

21. IEA/ARG on the Santo Cáliz components (n. 11 above).↩

22. Mafé's 1071 mounting dating as reported in the Valencia literature; the loose *urceus* usage: Lacarra glosses it "urna" (n. 4 above).↩

23. San Juan fires 1494/1675 and the 1835 dispersal: Artigrama 20 (2005) (n. 5 above).↩

24. M. Hesemann, *Inside the Vatican* (March 2006) — identification circulated with an unsupported goldsmith-commission mechanism; graded SPC.↩

25. IEA/ARG on the Santo Cáliz components (n. 11 above).↩

26. UPV metrology study (n. 12 above).↩

27. Route computation: pyproj 3.7.2 Geod (WGS84), executed in-session 5 October 2026; waypoint register in *Threshold Route — Ship's Logs* (Aureon sitting document).↩

28. Pytheas, *On the Ocean*, fragments: Strabo 1.4.2, 2.4.1; Pliny NH 4.30; Diodorus 5.21–22; Geminus 6.9.↩

29. Diodorus Siculus 2.47, citing Hecataeus of Abdera.↩

30. Adomnán, *Vita Sancti Columbae* 1.6, 2.42–43 (CELT L201040, UCC).↩

31. Adomnán, *Vita Sancti Columbae* (n. 19 above).↩

32. Dicuil, *Liber de Mensura Orbis Terrae* (c. 825) (CELT T090000-001).↩

33. *Íslendingabók* ch. 1; *Landnámabók* prologue; Papil cross-slab (HES SM2672); Faroes pre-Norse layers (barley/peat-ash, 4th–8th c.; sheep aDNA ~AD 500).↩

34. Jacopo da Varagine; William of Tyre — the Sacro Catino taken at Caesarea 1101; broken in Paris, 1806–16.↩

35. Ubieto Arteta, doc. 4 — the 1135 act (n. 2 above).↩

36. *Orkneyinga saga* ch. 93; Maeshowe runes (c. 1125–1175 forms).↩

37. H. Nicholson on the Irish Templar trial; the sea passage is the editor’s inference.↩

38. ACA perg. 136, 26 Sept 1399 (n. 7 above).↩

39. E. M. Carus-Wilson, *The Overseas Trade of Bristol* (Bristol Record Society 7, 1937); archive.org item bristol-record-society-07; originals TNA C 1.↩

40. S. Flavin and E. T. Jones (eds.), *Bristol’s Trade with Ireland and the Continent 1503–1601*, http://hdl.handle.net/1983/1297; TNA E 122/21/2.↩

41. T. Severin, *The Brendan Voyage* (Hutchinson, 1978).↩

42. Route computation (n. 16 above).↩

43. M. W. Miles et al., *Science Advances* 6 (2020), https://doi.org/10.1126/sciadv.aba4320; navigability verification annex (Aureon sitting, 5 Oct 2026).↩

44. See n. 25 above.↩

45. See n. 26 above.↩

46. Horus cippi rite: R. K. Ritner, *The Mechanics of Ancient Egyptian Magical Practice* (SAOC 54, 1993); Metternich Stela, MMA acc. 50.85.↩

47. Adomnán, *Vita Sancti Columbae* II.33 (n. 19 above).↩

48. Wolfram von Eschenbach, *Parzival* IX.468–471; motif anchors: S. Thompson, *Motif-Index* (1955–58), E80, D1338.1.1, D1500.1.18.5.↩

49. Antarctic clause: bed read via BAS geoserver at 89.19°S, 110.65°E (surface 2,965 m; bed −243 m; nearest radar bed echo 143 km); basal state: P. B. Price et al., *PNAS* 99 (2002), 7844–7847; T. A. Jordan et al., *Scientific Reports* 8 (2018), 16785; dataset: https://doi.org/10.5285/2d0e4791-8e20-46a3-80e4-f5f6716025d2.↩

50. Curling-stone physics: *Journal of Gemmology* 27 (2001) (ailsite: water absorption ≤0.51%); Harrison et al., Rb–Sr ~61 Ma, BGS memoir (nora.nerc.ac.uk 505002).↩

51. Biology clause: G. Koutsovoulos et al., *PNAS* 113 (2016), 5053–5058; T. Hashimoto et al., *Nature Communications* 7 (2016), 12808.↩